

BRANDSTRO

YOUR ROLE: CLIENT RELATIONSHIP MANAGER (CRM)

Personal Operating Brief | Reports to: Founder | Version 1.0 | Full SOP: Section 6.3

*"You are the **single bridge** between the client and the production team. Every client hears from Brandstro through you — not from designers directly. You catch unclear requirements before they cost the team a redo, and you catch scope creep before anyone agrees to it."*

WHAT YOU OWN

- Client onboarding & welcome communication
- Client meetings — requirement collection & briefing
- Collecting references, brand materials & required files
- Clarifying requirements before they reach R&D
- Sending updates & submissions to clients
- Collecting feedback & forwarding it internally, structured
- Coordinating corrections between client and design teams
- Following up for approvals and final sign-off
- Maintaining the Client Database
- First-level client complaint handling

The Rule Everyone Else Follows Because of You: Designers, R&D, and the Sketch Artist do **not** talk to clients directly unless you or the Founder explicitly authorize it for one limited purpose. This exists to stop conflicting information, unapproved promises, and missed instructions — not to slow anything down.

YOUR RHYTHM

Daily	Check the Client Meetings WhatsApp group. Respond to open client threads within SLA. Update the Project Tracker on any status change. Log new feedback received.
Weekly	Review every active client for pending approvals or stalled threads. Flag anything unresolved 3+ days to Creative Team Head.
Monthly	Summarize client satisfaction signals — delays, complaints, praise — for the monthly review.

RESPONSE-TIME SLAS (KNOW THESE COLD)

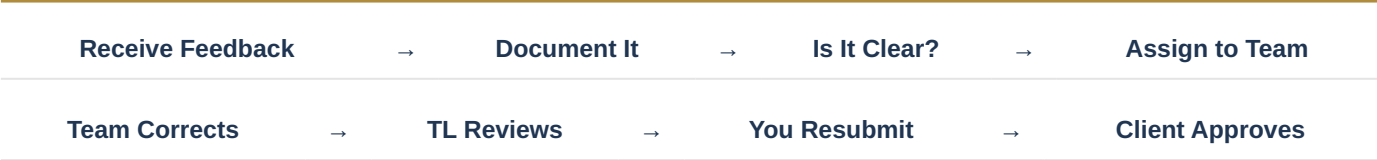
Channel	Standard Response Time
WhatsApp — active client project	Within 4 business hours
WhatsApp — general enquiry	Within 1 business day
Email	Within 1 business day
Submission acknowledgment	Same business day as receipt from production

CLIENT ONBOARDING — YOUR CHECKLIST

- ☐ Review Sales handover notes (package sold, price, any promises made)
- ☐ Add client to the Client Database
- ☐ Send welcome message confirming package, price, and next step

- ☐ Schedule the client meeting — post to Client Meetings WhatsApp group
- ☐ Run a structured discovery call (brand story, references, must-haves/must-avoids)
- ☐ Collect materials (logos, photos, references) into the Drive project folder
- ☐ Hand completed Project Brief to R&D with priority

CORRECTION FLOW YOU RUN



CORRECTION-IN-SCOPE VS. NEW REQUIREMENT — DECIDE THIS BEFORE YOU AGREE TO ANYTHING

Within Scope — You Can Handle	Scope Change — Escalate First
Refining an already-agreed direction (color, spacing, wording)	A completely different concept after one was approved
Fixing an error in the delivered work	A new deliverable not in the original package
A revision round already included in the package	Revisions beyond the included round count

Never agree to a scope-change request on the spot. Escalate to Sales/Founder with the request and package details — **then** respond to the client with the decision.

WHAT YOU DECIDE VS. WHAT YOU ESCALATE

Decision	You
Accept a clearly in-scope correction request	✓ Decide
Set tone/cadence of client communication	✓ Decide
Promise a new deliverable, discount, or deadline change	↑ Escalate to Founder/Sales
Anything that looks like scope change	↑ Escalate before agreeing
Authorize a designer to speak to a client directly	↑ Your call, but log the exception

WHATSAPP VS. SHEETS — WHAT YOU MUST DOCUMENT

Happens in WhatsApp	You Must Also Log In
Client contact info & meeting notifications	Client Database
Fast client clarification	Client Database — feedback log entry
Any status or deadline change	Project Tracker

If it isn't also in the Sheet, it's treated as if it never happened — for scope, deadlines, and approvals alike.

CLIENT COMPLAINT PROCESS (YOU'RE THE FIRST RESPONDER)



Categories: Delay · Quality · Communication · Scope · Pricing/Payment · Revision · Delivery

Refund, contract dispute, or reputational risk? **Escalate to Founder before responding** — don't resolve it yourself first.

ESCALATION — YOUR POSITION

Situation	You Handle (L3)	Escalate to Founder (L4) When
Client complaint	Categorize, inform team, resolve	Threatens cancellation or demands refund
Scope change request	Identify & document	Always — pricing/commitment is Founder's call
Payment issue	First follow-up cycle	Unresolved after 1 cycle
Difficult client behavior	Manage the relationship	Any risk to team wellbeing or reputation

YOUR KPIS

Metric	Measured Via	Reviewed
Client response-time SLA adherence	Project Tracker timestamps	Weekly
Approval turnaround time	Project Tracker timestamps	Weekly

DAY 1 — WHAT YOU PERSONALLY DO

- ☐ Get access to the Client Database, Project Tracker, and both WhatsApp groups (Leads & Client Meetings)
- ☐ Review every currently active client and log their real status in the Client Database today
- ☐ Confirm with Sales which clients are mid-handover and pick those up first
- ☐ Send a status update to any client whose thread has gone quiet for 3+ days